

Strategies Page — Improvement Requirements

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Summary

The Strategies page solves the arithmetic of a goal but doesn't tell users whether the plan is likely to work, how risky it is, or why its picks deserve trust. Ship STRAT-1 and STRAT-2 first for credibility, then STRAT-3 and STRAT-4 for relevance.

ID	Story	Priority	Why it matters
STRAT-1	Probability of success and feasibility verdict	P0	A single solved return hides the odds and the range of outcomes
STRAT-2	Candidates tied to Scan evidence	P0	Today Scan says nothing beat holding, yet Strategies can still suggest picks
STRAT-3	Risk profile, allocation and stock cap	P1	No risk input; the 5-year warning is advice, not a control
STRAT-4	Goal presets, account types and taxes	P1	Missing 401(k)/529/HSA, contribution limits, and Traditional vs Roth after-tax value
STRAT-5	Saved plans, progress tracking, AI explanation	P2	A plan ends at "Build Plan" with no follow-up
STRAT-6	Input clarity and cleanup	P2	Confusing labels and unclear solved vs input fields
STRAT-7	Advisor mode for RIA white-label	P2	Needed to sell the platform to advisors

STRAT-1 Probability of success and feasibility verdict (P0)

Story. As a user building a plan, I want to see my chance of reaching the goal and the range of likely outcomes, so that I know whether the plan is realistic before I commit to it.

Acceptance criteria

1. After "Build Plan," the result leads with the Monte Carlo success rate: "72% chance of reaching \$X by 2031."
2. A balance-over-time chart shows the 10th, 50th and 90th percentile paths and the target line.
3. A verdict badge appears: Realistic ($\geq 75\%$), Stretch (50–74%), Unlikely ($< 50\%$); thresholds are configurable.
4. When solving for required return, the result compares it to historical ranges for the chosen allocation (e.g. "You need 11.2%/yr; a 60/40 mix has historically returned about 7–8%") with the data period stated.
5. For Stretch or Unlikely plans, show the single smallest change that reaches Realistic for each lever: extra monthly contribution, extra years, or lower target.
6. Simulation settings (runs, return and volatility assumptions, data period) are visible in an "Assumptions" panel.
7. Results are reproducible: same inputs and seed give the same success rate.

STRAT-2 Candidates tied to Scan evidence (P0)

Story. As a user, I want the stocks and strategies a plan suggests to carry their evidence, so that I'm never shown picks the Scan page already found didn't work.

Acceptance criteria

1. Stock and strategy candidates come only from templates that passed the Scan robustness checks (Scan stories SCAN-3, SCAN-4 and SCAN-6).
2. Each candidate shows its evidence in one line, e.g. "Beat holding in 31 of 50 samples; worst window –12%."
3. When no template passes, the plan uses an index-fund core only and says why: "No stock strategy passed testing on current data."
4. Plans use a core / satellite structure: the core is broad funds from the selected categories; picks are a separate satellite slice.
5. Fund candidates show expense ratio, 5-year return and max drawdown, and are ranked on risk-adjusted return, not raw return.
6. Every candidate links to its Scan result or fund page.

STRAT-3 Risk profile, allocation and stock cap (P1)

Story. As a user, I want the plan's mix of stocks, bonds and individual picks set from my risk tolerance and timeline, so that I don't take on more risk than I can hold through a downturn.

Acceptance criteria

1. A short risk question set (3–5 questions, e.g. "If this fell 30% in year 3, would you sell?") produces a profile: Conservative, Moderate or Growth.
2. The profile and years to goal set a target allocation (e.g. 70% stock funds, 25% bonds, 5% picks), which the user can adjust.
3. The allocation shifts toward bonds as the goal date approaches (a glide path); the schedule is shown.
4. The 5-year warning becomes a control: a slider capping individual stocks, default 10%, maximum 20% when the horizon is under 7 years.
5. Results show the plan's historical worst drop in dollars ("In 2022 this mix would have fallen about \$18,000").
6. Changing the profile or cap re-runs STRAT-1 and updates the success rate.

STRAT-4 Goal presets, account types and taxes (P1)

Story. As a user, I want to start from my real goal and account, so that the plan reflects the limits and taxes that actually apply to me.

Acceptance criteria

1. Goal presets — Retirement, House down payment, College, Emergency fund, Custom — set a default horizon, account type and risk profile.
2. Account types include Taxable, Traditional IRA/401(k), Roth IRA/401(k), 529 and HSA.
3. Contributions are checked against the current year's IRS annual limits for the chosen account; overages are flagged with the limit shown. Limits live in a config table updated each year.
4. Traditional accounts ask for an expected tax rate at withdrawal and show the after-tax amount next to the pre-tax balance.
5. The flat 0.5% taxable drag is replaced by an estimate from each fund's yield and turnover, shown in Assumptions.
6. Each fund's expense ratio is subtracted from its return in the simulation.

7. Results default to today's dollars, with the future-dollar amount shown underneath.

STRAT-5 Saved plans, progress tracking and AI explanation (P2)

Story. As a user, I want to save a plan, see how I'm tracking against it, and get a plain-language explanation, so that the plan stays useful after the first day.

Acceptance criteria

1. Users can save multiple named plans; each stores inputs, assumptions, allocation and seed.
2. A saved plan shows actual balance (entered or linked) against its percentile bands over time, reusing the live track record feature.
3. If the balance falls below the 25th-percentile path, the user gets an alert: "Off track — add \$X/month or extend 1 year."
4. An AI explanation (same service as signal explanations) summarizes in under 120 words: why this allocation, the main risk, and what changed since the last review.
5. Market sentiment and regime scores may appear as context but never change a saved plan's allocation automatically.
6. A plan can be exported as a PDF summary.

STRAT-6 Input clarity and cleanup (P2)

Story. As a first-time user, I want every input to be clear, so that I can build a plan without guessing what a field means.

Acceptance criteria

1. The field being solved for is locked and tagged "Solved"; all others are inputs.
2. Universe labels use plain words with a count, e.g. "Large US companies (S&P 500, ~500 stocks)" instead of "US - Mega Cap (SPY sample)".
3. "Picks per strategy" gets a tooltip and a sensible default (e.g. 5).
4. Every input has a one-sentence tooltip and a valid range; out-of-range values show an inline error.
5. Inputs are validated before "Build Plan" (e.g. years to goal ≥ 1 , contribution ≥ 0).
6. The page works at phone width with no horizontal scroll.

STRAT-7 Advisor mode for RIA white-label (P2)

Story. As an advisor using the white-labeled platform, I want to build and save plans for clients, so that I can use Strategies in client meetings and keep a record of the assumptions.

Acceptance criteria

1. Advisors can create client profiles and attach multiple plans to each.
2. Each plan exports as a branded PDF (firm logo, advisor name, date) including the success rate, allocation, assumptions and disclosures.
3. An assumptions log records who changed what and when, for compliance review.
4. Firm admins can set default assumptions (return, volatility, inflation) and disclosure text for all advisors.
5. Advisor mode is enabled per tenant and hidden from retail users.

Open questions

- ☐ Which historical data period and return/volatility assumptions drive the Monte Carlo (STRAT-1)?
- ☐ Should STRAT-2 wait for Scan robustness work (SCAN-3, SCAN-4, SCAN-6), or ship with an index-only default first?
- ☐ Where do linked balances come from for progress tracking — manual entry or a brokerage connection?
- ☐ Does advice-like output (risk profile, allocation) require RIA registration or specific disclosures for retail users?
- ☐ Who maintains the annual IRS contribution-limit table?